KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 4: SHAPES AND SPACE · WEEK 18 · READING

The Lot on Linden Street — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students identify the parts of an argument (claim, reasons, evidence, counterclaim and rebuttal), tell evidence (a fact that can be checked) from opinion, compare two opinion letters on the same issue, judge which evidence is strongest and relevant, use commas after introductory words and in a series, and paraphrase evidence honestly with the source named.

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Slide 0 — Intro and name capture: neighbors on Linden Street in Detroit disagree about an empty lot: a community garden or more parking? The student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the scoring rules together: 2 tries per question, Pathway Points only for a correct first try, and the answer plus the reason appear after the 2nd miss. Typed one-word answers ignore capital letters and are accepted when the answer contains an accepted word.
2. Slide 1 — Warm-Up: Week 17 Review (8 pts, 4 each): reading drama (stage directions and what they reveal).
3. Slide 2 — Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W18.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre-Lesson Warm-Up) on paper before any teaching.
4. Slide 3 — Picture It: The Parts of an Argument. Claim, reasons, evidence, counterclaim, rebuttal and conclusion. Stress: an argument is a plan to persuade, not a fight.
5. Slide 4 — Vocabulary Round-Up: 6 flip cards (claim, reason, evidence, counterclaim, rebuttal, persuade).
6. Slide 5 — Your Turn: Using the Words (8 pts, 4 each): one multiple-choice and one typed vocabulary item.
7. Slide 6 — Letter A: Let Linden Street Grow (5 pts). Read it aloud; mark the claim, each reason, the evidence, and how the writer answers the other side.
8. Slide 7 — Letter B: Linden Street Needs Parking (5 pts): a shop owner argues the other side. Compare it with Letter A.
9. Slide 8 — Name That Part (10 pts, 5 each): ask what job each sentence does (claim, reason, evidence, counterclaim or rebuttal).
10. Slide 9 — Teach: Build an Argument Like a Pro. Five steps, with signal words like First, Second, However and For these reasons.
11. Slide 10 — Argument Detective (12 pts, 6 each): judge the evidence, find the mistakes, and look closely at the numbers.
12. Slide 11 — Fix the Sentence, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): each item names the one kind of fix. The whole sentence is checked exactly (straight or curly quotes and extra spaces are OK). The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
13. Slide 12 — Fix the Sentence, Part 2 (8 pts, 4 each): two more sentences, same rules. Series items accept the list with or without the comma before and.

14. Slide 13 — Comma Combine (4 pts): combine three choppy sentences into one sentence with a series. Checked exactly; with or without the comma before and.
15. Slide 14 — Writer's Turn: Evidence in Your Own Words (6 pts): one typed answer auto-checked by rules: a minimum word count; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (allowed names count as one word); and every key idea included. Feedback names the rule that was missed, and a model answer appears after the 2nd miss. Encourage covering the original before writing.
16. Slide 15 — Match-Up Round (10 pts): argument words and signal phrases matched to their jobs, 2 pts each on the first try.
17. Slide 16 — Speed Trail (bonus XP only): 3 quick questions against the student's own best time.
18. Slide 17 — Boss Challenge (16 pts, 8 each): two-step items that check every part of an argument and compare the two letters.
19. Slide 18 — Pencil Break (Post): the student completes Page 2 (Post-Lesson Activity) of the same sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W18.pdf), including the writing item and the ★ Challenge if time allows, before seeing the score.
20. Slide 19 — Results (Argument Ready!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows "Argument Ace!" with the congratulations message "Argument ace! You could judge the Linden Street debate for the city council!" and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows "Keep Going!" with encouragement ("You're getting closer, and every try makes you stronger."), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: WEEK 17 REVIEW (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
`rv1_s0`	Set 1: Type your answer: in a play script, the notes in parentheses that tell actors how to move or speak, like (She slams the door.), are called ___.	**stage directions** (also accepted: stage direction, stage notes)	Notes like (She slams the door.) tell actors how to move or speak. They are called stage directions (Week 17).
`rv2_s0`	Set 1: GRANDPA: (grumbling) Fine, fine, take the last biscuit. I wasn't hungry anyway. (He smiles when she turns away.) Which explanation of Grandpa's character is correct? [He pretends to be grumpy, but the stage direction shows he is really glad to share. / He is angry, because he grumbles. / He is not hungry, because he says so. / We cannot learn anything about him from stage directions.]	**He pretends to be grumpy, but the stage direction shows he is really glad to share.**	He grumbles out loud, but the stage direction shows him smiling once she turns away. His words act grumpy, yet his actions show he is happy to share (Week 17).
`rv1_s1`	Set 2: Type your answer: the list of characters printed at the beginning of a play is called the ___.	**cast** (also accepted: cast list, cast of characters, character list, list of characters)	The list of characters at the start of a play is the cast, sometimes called the cast of characters (Week 17).

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
rv2_s1	Set 2: A story says: “Mia was nervous, so she twisted her sleeve.” How would a play script MOST likely show the same moment? [MIA: (twisting her sleeve) Is it my turn already? / Mia was nervous, so she twisted her sleeve. / ACT 1: Mia is nervous. / CAST: Mia, a nervous girl who twists her sleeve, then the end.]	**MIA: (twisting her sleeve) Is it my turn already?**	A play shows feelings through dialogue and stage directions instead of a narrator. The stage direction (twisting her sleeve) shows that Mia is nervous (Week 17).
rv1_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: a play is divided into acts, and each act is divided into smaller parts called ___.	**scene** (also accepted: scenes)	Acts are the big parts of a play, and each act is divided into smaller parts called scenes (Week 17).
rv2_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Wesley says, “In a play, the actors read the stage directions out loud to the audience.” Which explanation is correct? [Wesley is wrong. Stage directions tell actors what to do; the audience sees the actions but does not hear the directions. / Wesley is right. Every word in a script is spoken aloud. / Wesley is wrong. Stage directions are the list of characters. / Wesley is right. Stage directions are the same thing as dialogue.]	**Wesley is wrong. Stage directions tell actors what to do; the audience sees the actions but does not hear the directions.**	Stage directions are for the actors and the director. The audience sees them acted out but usually does not hear them read aloud (Week 17).

YOUR TURN: USING THE WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s0	Set 1: Nadia writes, “My claim is simple: the city should turn this lot into a community garden.” In this sentence, claim means ___. [the main opinion she wants readers to agree with / a fact that no one could disagree with / a number from a survey / the other side’s point of view]	**the main opinion she wants readers to agree with**	Her claim is the main opinion of the whole letter, the thing she wants the council to agree with and vote for.
v2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: the facts, numbers, and examples a writer uses to prove a reason are called ___.	**evidence**	Facts, numbers, examples, and expert words that prove a reason are called evidence.
v1_s1	Set 2: After stating the parking side, Nadia writes, “However, our newsletter’s survey of 120 shoppers found that 84 of them walked or took the bus.” This sentence is her rebuttal. A rebuttal is ___. [an answer that shows why the other side’s point is weaker / a sentence that agrees with the other side / the title of a letter / a list of the writer’s favorite things]	**an answer that shows why the other side’s point is weaker**	A rebuttal answers the other side. Nadia uses survey numbers to show the parking worry is weaker than it sounds.
v2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: the other side’s opinion, which a strong writer states fairly and then answers, is called the ___.	**counterclaim** (also accepted: counter claim, counter-claim, counterclaims, counterargument, counter argument, counter-argument, opposing claim)	The other side’s opinion is called the counterclaim. A strong writer states it fairly and then answers it.
v1_s2	Set 3: Nadia ends her letter, “For these reasons, I urge you to vote yes on the Linden Street garden.” Here, urge means ___. [to strongly ask or encourage / to quietly wonder / to refuse / to forget about something]	**to strongly ask or encourage**	To urge someone is to ask or encourage them strongly. Nadia is pressing the council to vote yes.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: both letter writers want to ___ the city council, which means to convince the council to agree and vote their way.	**persuade** (also accepted: persuading, convince, convincing)	To persuade means to convince someone to agree with you or to do something. Both letters try to persuade the city council.

LETTER A: LET LINDEN STREET GROW (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sa_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Nadia's claim is that the city should turn the lot into a ___.	**community garden** (also accepted: garden, community gardens)	Paragraph 1 states the claim: "the city should turn this lot into a community garden, not a parking lot."
sa_s1	Set 2: Two-step: use paragraph 5. How many MORE shoppers walked or took the bus than drove? Type a number.	**48** (also accepted: forty-eight, forty eight)	Step 1: paragraph 5 says 84 walked or took the bus and 36 drove. Step 2: 84 − 36 = 48 more shoppers walked or took the bus.
sa_s2	Set 3: Which sentence from Nadia's letter is EVIDENCE, not a reason or the claim? [The nearest grocery store is two miles away, and many neighbors do not have cars. / First, a garden would give families fresh food. / The city should turn this lot into a community garden, not a parking lot. / Let's grow something good together.]	**The nearest grocery store is two miles away, and many neighbors do not have cars.**	"The nearest grocery store is two miles away..." is a fact that can be checked, so it is evidence. "First, a garden would give families fresh food" is the reason it proves, and the other two sentences are the claim and the closing.

LETTER B: LINDEN STREET NEEDS PARKING (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sb_s0	Set 1: Which sentence from Mr. Lin's letter is an OPINION, not evidence? [Still, gardens are nice, but jobs are more important. / Last year, my store lost at least 40 sales because customers could not find a place to park. / My family has run Lin's Hardware on Linden Street for 31 years. / Some double-park in front of the bus stop.]	**Still, gardens are nice, but jobs are more important.**	"Gardens are nice, but jobs are more important" tells what Mr. Lin thinks; it cannot be checked, so it is an opinion, not evidence. The lost sales, the 31 years, and the double-parking can all be checked.
sb_s1	Set 2: Mr. Lin's first reason is that shops need customers who drive. Type the one word that finishes his second reason: "Parking also keeps our street ___."	**safe** (also accepted: safer, safety)	Paragraph 3 begins, "Parking also keeps our street safe." That is his second reason.
sb_s2	Set 3: Mr. Lin's main reason is that shops need customers who drive. Which detail from Nadia's letter BEST answers that reason? [84 of 120 shoppers surveyed walked or took the bus. / The Hamilton Street garden grew more than 900 pounds of vegetables. / Plants soak up rainwater. / The lot holds an old shopping cart.]	**84 of 120 shoppers surveyed walked or took the bus.**	Mr. Lin's main reason is that shops need customers who drive. Nadia's survey shows that most shoppers (84 of 120) did not drive, which answers his reason with numbers.

NAME THAT PART (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
c1_s0	Set 1: Paragraph 4: "Plants soak up rainwater, so less water floods the basements on our block after a storm." What job does this sentence do? [It is evidence that supports the reason "a garden helps the whole street." / It is Nadia's claim. / It is the counterclaim. / It is the rebuttal to Mr. Lin.]	**It is evidence that supports the reason "a garden helps the whole street."**	Paragraph 4's reason is "a garden helps the whole street." The sentence about rainwater and basements is a checkable fact that proves that reason, so it is evidence.
c2_s0	Set 1: Type one word: in Nadia's letter, "Some neighbors argue that Linden Street needs more parking for the shops" is the ___.	**counterclaim** (also accepted: counter claim, counter-claim, counterargument, counter argument, counter-argument, opposing claim)	This sentence tells the other side's view (parking), so it is the counterclaim. Nadia states it fairly, then answers it.
c1_s1	Set 2: Which sentence could be a CLAIM (an opinion that people could argue about)? [Every town should have at least one community garden. / The Hamilton Street garden is six blocks east of Linden Street. / The lot has been empty for six years. / The survey asked 120 shoppers how they got to Linden Street.]	**Every town should have at least one community garden.**	"Every town should have at least one community garden" is an opinion people could argue about, so it can be a claim. The other three are facts that could be checked.
c2_s1	Set 2: Type one word: Nadia writes, "However, our newsletter's survey of 120 shoppers found that 84 of them walked or took the bus." She uses this to answer the other side. This part of an argument is the ___.	**rebuttal** (also accepted: rebuttals, refutation, rebut)	Nadia uses the survey to answer the other side's parking point. An answer to a counterclaim is a rebuttal.
c1_s2	Set 3: Felix says, "Mrs. Okafor's words in paragraph 3 don't count as evidence, because she is just one person." Which explanation is correct? [Felix is wrong. The words of an expert, like a science teacher talking about her own students, are evidence for the reason that a garden is a place to learn. / Felix is right. Only numbers can ever be evidence. / Felix is right. Quotes are always opinions. / Felix is wrong, because Mrs. Okafor's words are Nadia's claim.]	**Felix is wrong. The words of an expert, like a science teacher talking about her own students, are evidence for the reason that a garden is a place to learn.**	Words from an expert are one kind of evidence. Mrs. Okafor is a science teacher speaking about what her own students could study, so her words support Nadia's second reason.
c2_s2	Set 3: Type one word: "First, a garden would give families fresh food" is a ___ that supports Nadia's claim.	**reason** (also accepted: reasons)	"First, a garden would give families fresh food" tells WHY Nadia believes her claim, so it is a reason. The facts after it are the evidence.

ARGUMENT DETECTIVE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s0	Set 1: Talia's claim: "Our town library should open on Sundays." Which is the STRONGEST evidence for her claim? [Last year, 210 people signed a list asking the library for Sunday hours. / Sunday is the best day of the week for reading. / The library has thousands of books. / I really, really want the library open on Sundays.]	**Last year, 210 people signed a list asking the library for Sunday hours.**	A signed list of 210 people is a fact that can be checked, and it shows real demand for Sunday hours. The other choices are feelings, or true facts that do not prove the claim.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d2_s0	Set 1: Find the mistake! Ravi wrote: “Our school should start later. Kids need more sleep. Some people think school should start earlier. I like sleeping.” What is the BIGGEST problem? [He gives no evidence for his reason, and his answer to the counterclaim is only a feeling. / He has no claim at all. / He should never mention the other side. / His claim is a fact, so no one can disagree.]	**He gives no evidence for his reason, and his answer to the counterclaim is only a feeling.**	Ravi never proves “Kids need more sleep” with a fact, and “I like sleeping” is a feeling, so it does not answer the counterclaim. He does have a claim, and naming the other side is a good thing.
d1_s1	Set 2: Two-step: Nadia’s survey found that 36 of 120 shoppers drove. What fraction of the shoppers drove? Type it in simplest form (for example, 1/2).	**3/10** (also accepted: 30%, 30 %, 30 percent, 3 out of 10, three out of ten, three tenths, three-tenths, 0.3, .3)	Step 1: 36 of the 120 shoppers drove, so the fraction is 36/120. Step 2: divide the top and bottom by 12 to get 3/10, which is 30 percent. Most shoppers did not drive.
d2_s1	Set 2: Which sentence states the parking side’s counterclaim FAIRLY? [Some neighbors worry that shoppers will have nowhere to park. / Only selfish people want a parking lot. / Everyone on Linden Street agrees with me. / Gardens grow vegetables.]	**Some neighbors worry that shoppers will have nowhere to park.**	A fair counterclaim states the other side’s real worry in a respectful way. Calling people selfish is name-calling, and the other choices do not state the other side at all.
d1_s2	Set 3: Nadia’s reason: “A garden would give families fresh food.” Which detail is NOT relevant evidence for that reason? [The lot is at the corner of Linden Street and Ash Avenue. / The nearest grocery store is two miles away. / Many neighbors do not have cars. / The Hamilton Street garden grew more than 900 pounds of vegetables.]	**The lot is at the corner of Linden Street and Ash Avenue.**	Where the lot is located does not show that a garden would feed families. The garden’s harvest, the distance to the store, and neighbors without cars all connect to fresh food.
d2_s2	Set 3: Sofia’s claim is “Our town should build a skate park.” Her reason is “Kids need a safe place to skate.” Type the ONE linking word that joins them: Our town should build a skate park ___ kids need a safe place to skate.	**because** (also accepted: since)	“Because” (or “since”) joins a claim to the reason that explains why: Our town should build a skate park because kids need a safe place to skate.

FIX THE SENTENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs1_s0	Set 1: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. However the survey shows that most shoppers walk.	**However, the survey shows that most shoppers walk.**	“However” is an introductory word, so a comma follows it.
fs2_s0	Set 1: Commas in a series: add the missing commas. Students could study soil insects and plant life cycles.	**Students could study soil, insects, and plant life cycles.** (also accepted: Students could study soil, insects and plant life cycles.)	Soil, insects, and plant life cycles are three items in a series, so a comma goes after each item except the last.
fs3_s0	Set 1: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. First a garden would give families fresh food.	**First, a garden would give families fresh food.**	“First” introduces a reason, so a comma follows it.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs4_s0	Set 1: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. (Hint: what is the subject?) The neighbors on Ash Avenue wants a garden.	**The neighbors on Ash Avenue want a garden.**	The subject is “neighbors,” which is plural, so the verb is “want.” The words “on Ash Avenue” do not change the subject.
fs1_s1	Set 2: Comma after an introductory phrase: add the missing comma. In addition neighbors who garden together get to know each other.	**In addition, neighbors who garden together get to know each other.**	“In addition” is an introductory phrase, so a comma follows it.
fs2_s1	Set 2: Commas in a series: add the missing commas. Customers buy soil paint and lumber at Lin's Hardware.	**Customers buy soil, paint, and lumber at Lin's Hardware.** (also accepted: Customers buy soil, paint and lumber at Lin's Hardware.)	Soil, paint, and lumber are three items in a series, so a comma goes after each item except the last.
fs3_s1	Set 2: Both comma rules: add ALL the missing commas. Yes the garden would need water tools and volunteers.	**Yes, the garden would need water, tools, and volunteers.** (also accepted: Yes, the garden would need water, tools and volunteers.)	Two rules at once: a comma after the introductory word “Yes,” and commas between the three items water, tools, and volunteers.
fs4_s1	Set 2: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. A parking lot help only a few drivers.	**A parking lot helps only a few drivers.**	“A parking lot” is singular, so it needs the singular verb “helps.”
fs1_s2	Set 3: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. Finally a garden helps the whole street.	**Finally, a garden helps the whole street.**	“Finally” introduces the last reason, so a comma follows it.
fs2_s2	Set 3: Commas in a series: add the missing commas. (Careful: some items are more than one word.) The lot holds weeds broken glass and an old shopping cart.	**The lot holds weeds, broken glass, and an old shopping cart.** (also accepted: The lot holds weeds, broken glass and an old shopping cart.)	Weeds, broken glass, and an old shopping cart are three items in a series. Some items are more than one word, but the commas still go after each item except the last.
fs3_s2	Set 3: Both comma rules: add ALL the missing commas. For example tomatoes peppers and beans grow well in Detroit summers.	**For example, tomatoes, peppers, and beans grow well in Detroit summers.** (also accepted: For example, tomatoes, peppers and beans grow well in Detroit summers.)	Two rules at once: a comma after the introductory phrase “For example,” and commas between the three items tomatoes, peppers, and beans.
fs4_s2	Set 3: Grammar: fix the their / there / they’re mistake. The neighbors brought they're own shovels.	**The neighbors brought their own shovels.**	“They’re” means “they are.” The shovels belong to the neighbors, so use the possessive “their.”

COMMA COMBINE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s0	Set 1: Combine these into one sentence with a series. Three short sentences: The garden would need shovels. The garden would need seeds. The garden would need a water hose. Start with: The garden would need	**The garden would need shovels, seeds, and a water hose.** (also accepted: The garden would need shovels, seeds and a water hose.)	Keep “The garden would need” once, then list the three items with commas between them and “and” before the last one.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s1	Set 2: Combine these into one sentence with a series of actions. Three short sentences: Drivers circle the block. Drivers honk their horns. Drivers double-park by the bus stop. Start with: Drivers	**Drivers circle the block, honk their horns, and double-park by the bus stop.** (also accepted: Drivers circle the block, honk their horns and double-park by the bus stop.)	A series can list actions, too. Keep "Drivers" once, then list the three actions with commas between them and "and" before the last one.
qt_s2	Set 3: Combine these into one sentence. Use both comma rules. Three short sentences: Gardens give birds a home. Gardens give bees a home. Gardens give butterflies a home. Start with: In addition (then a comma), and keep the order birds, bees, butterflies.	**In addition, gardens give birds, bees, and butterflies a home.** (also accepted: In addition, gardens give birds, bees and butterflies a home.; In addition, gardens give a home to birds, bees, and butterflies.; In addition, gardens give a home to birds, bees and butterflies.)	Both rules: a comma after the introductory phrase "In addition," and commas between birds, bees, and butterflies.

WRITER'S TURN: EVIDENCE IN YOUR OWN WORDS (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s0	Set 1: Write this evidence in your own words, and name the source in your sentence. Original (Letter A, paragraph 2, by Nadia Brooks): Last spring, the Hamilton Street garden, six blocks east, grew more than 900 pounds of vegetables, and gardeners shared much of it with neighbors. Use at least 8 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the original. (The name Hamilton Street and the number 900 are fine to keep.) Name the source: include the writer's name, Nadia Brooks. Keep the key idea: include the number 900 (or nine hundred). Keep the key idea: say what was grown (vegetables, food, or crops). Original: "Last spring, the Hamilton Street garden, six blocks east, grew more than 900 pounds of vegetables, and gardeners shared much of it with neighbors."	**Sample:** Nadia Brooks points out that a nearby garden on Hamilton Street produced over 900 pounds of food in one spring and gave a lot of it away.	A strong sentence names Nadia Brooks, keeps the number 900 and the idea of vegetables, and says the rest in new words and a new sentence pattern. The name Hamilton Street can stay the same. Auto-check rubric: at least 8 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: brooks or nadia; 900 or nine hundred; vegetable or food or produce or crop or harvest or tomato or bean.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s1	Set 2: Write this evidence in your own words, and name the source in your sentence. Original (Letter B, paragraph 2, by Harold Lin): When people buy heavy things, like bags of soil, paint, or lumber, they cannot carry them home on the bus. Use at least 8 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the original. (Single words like heavy, bus, soil, or lumber are fine to keep.) Name the source: include the writer's name, Harold Lin (or Mr. Lin). Keep the key idea: say the items are heavy (heavy, big, bulky, or large). Keep the key idea: mention the bus. Original: "When people buy heavy things, like bags of soil, paint, or lumber, they cannot carry them home on the bus."	**Sample:** Harold Lin explains that shoppers who ride the bus have trouble taking big items, such as lumber, back to their homes.	A strong sentence names Harold Lin, keeps the ideas of heavy items and the bus, and says the rest in new words and a new sentence pattern. Auto-check rubric: at least 8 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: lin or lin' or harold; heavy or big or bulky or large or huge or weigh; bus.
wt_s2	Set 3: Write this evidence in your own words, and name the source in your sentence. Original (Letter A, paragraph 4, by Nadia Brooks): Plants soak up rainwater, so less water floods the basements on our block after a storm. Use at least 8 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the original. (Single words like water or basements are fine to keep.) Name the source: include the writer's name, Nadia Brooks. Keep the key idea: mention the rain or water. Keep the key idea: mention the flooding or the basements. Original: "Plants soak up rainwater, so less water floods the basements on our block after a storm."	**Sample:** Nadia Brooks notes that garden plants take in water from storms, which means fewer homes nearby end up with wet, flooded basements.	A strong sentence names Nadia Brooks, keeps the ideas of rainwater and flooded basements, and changes the rest of the words and the sentence pattern. Auto-check rubric: at least 8 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: brooks or nadia; rain or water or storm; flood or basement.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match claim	**the main opinion a writer argues**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match reason	**why the writer believes the claim**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match evidence	**facts or numbers that prove a reason**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match counterclaim	**the other side's opinion**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match rebuttal	**an answer to the other side**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match fact	**can be checked and proven true**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match opinion	**what someone thinks or feels**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match persuade	**to convince someone to agree**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match relevant	**connected to the reason or claim**	2 points if matched on the first try.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match conclusion	**the ending that restates the claim**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match However,	**signals a rebuttal**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match For example,	**signals evidence**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match First,	**signals the first reason**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match Some people say	**signals a counterclaim**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match For these reasons,	**signals the conclusion**	2 points if matched on the first try.

BOSS CHALLENGE (8 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b1_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Jonah wrote, “Our town should plant more trees. First trees give shade on hot days. Some people say trees cost too much. However the town saves money when shade trees lower summer cooling bills.” Which list names ALL of his comma mistakes? [Add a comma after First and a comma after However. / Add a comma after First only. / Add a comma after However only. / Add a comma after Some people and after trees.]	**Add a comma after First and a comma after However.**	“First” and “However” are both introductory words, so each needs a comma after it. No comma belongs after “Some people” or after “trees,” because they are not introductory words.
b2_s0	Set 1: Compare paragraph 5 of Letter A with paragraph 4 of Letter B. Which explanation BEST shows why Nadia’s rebuttal is stronger than Mr. Lin’s? [Nadia answers the other side with survey numbers, but Mr. Lin answers it with an opinion that cannot be checked. / Mr. Lin never mentions the other side at all. / Nadia never mentions the other side at all. / Nadia’s letter is longer, so it must be stronger.]	**Nadia answers the other side with survey numbers, but Mr. Lin answers it with an opinion that cannot be checked.**	Both writers mention the other side, but Mr. Lin answers it with an opinion (“jobs are more important”), while Nadia answers it with survey numbers that can be checked. Length does not make an argument stronger.
b1_s1	Set 2: Nadia’s sentence “Neighbors who garden together get to know each other” has no evidence. Which addition would make her letter STRONGEST? [At the Hamilton Street garden, about 40 neighbors meet every Saturday to plant and weed together. / Gardens are the best thing that could ever happen to a street! / Remove the counterclaim so readers only see her side. / Oranges grow well in Florida.]	**At the Hamilton Street garden, about 40 neighbors meet every Saturday to plant and weed together.**	Nadia’s last reason (neighbors get to know each other) has no evidence yet. A checkable fact about neighbors meeting at the Hamilton Street garden proves it. Opinions, removing the counterclaim, and facts about another state would all weaken the letter.
b2_s1	Set 2: Two-step: Bea wrote, “In addition the garden would give kids a place to play learn and explore.” Which version fixes ALL the comma mistakes? [In addition, the garden would give kids a place to play, learn, and explore. / In addition the garden would give kids a place to play, learn, and explore. / In addition, the garden would give kids a place to play learn and explore. / In addition, the garden, would give kids, a place to play, learn, and, explore.]	**In addition, the garden would give kids a place to play, learn, and explore.**	“In addition” needs a comma after it, and play, learn, and explore are three items in a series that need commas between them. The last choice adds commas where they do not belong.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b1_s2	Set 3: Two-step: Mr. Lin worries about losing sales, and his letter says customers buy bags of soil at his store. Thinking like Nadia, which is the SMARTEST rebuttal to his worry? [Gardeners will need soil and tools, so a garden next door could bring his store new customers. / Mr. Lin should close his store. / Hardware stores are boring. / Parking lots are always bad.]	**Gardeners will need soil and tools, so a garden next door could bring his store new customers.**	Mr. Lin worries about losing sales, and he says customers buy soil at his store. Gardeners need soil and tools, so a garden next door could bring him customers. That answers his worry with a reason he cares about. The other choices are rude or are opinions.
b2_s2	Set 3: Two-step: Marisa wrote, "My claim is that every school should have a garden. For example gardens are fun." What TWO problems does this have? [A comma is missing after "For example," and "gardens are fun" is an opinion, not evidence. / The claim is a fact, and the commas are all correct. / There is only one problem: "every" should be capitalized. / A writer should never use "For example" in an argument.]	**A comma is missing after "For example," and "gardens are fun" is an opinion, not evidence.**	"For example" is an introductory phrase that needs a comma, and "gardens are fun" is an opinion that cannot be checked, so it is not real evidence.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W18.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Review: story sentence to script line	GRANDPA: (laughing) That's my favorite song.
2	F or O	a) F b) O c) F d) O
3	Your opinion and one reason	Answers vary. Check for a clear opinion and a reason that tells why.
4	Add the missing commas	The garden club needs seeds, shovels, and a hose. (Also accept without the comma before and.)
5	When a writer tries to persuade you...	convince you to agree

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Label each sentence	(1) claim (2) reason (3) evidence (4) counterclaim (5) rebuttal
2	Add ALL the missing commas	a) In addition, the garden would need soil, seeds, and benches. b) However, most shoppers on Linden Street walk or take the bus.
3	Stronger evidence for Nadia's reason	60 Linden Street families have no car to reach a grocery store. (It is a checkable fact; the other choice is an opinion.)
4	Writing: bike lanes paragraph	Grading note: a claim; two reasons beginning "First," and "Second,"; one checkable fact as evidence; a list of three with commas.

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Add a counterclaim and a “However,” rebuttal	Grading note: states the other side fairly, then answers it with a fact; comma after However.